NovaCart Support Playbook: Product & Warranty

Category: Product & Warranty | **Document ID:** SOP-OPS-PW-03 | **Version:** 2026.4 | **Scope:** Tier 1-3 Support

Section 1: Warranty Verification, Coverage Scope & Brand Partnerships

1.1 Objective: This document codifies technical diagnostics, Dead-On-Arrival (DOA) classifications, warranty entitlements, and Authorized Service Center (ASC) escalation protocols across all retail merchandise on NovaCart.

1.2 Multi-Tiered Warranty Structure

- **NovaCart 30-Day Platform Assurance:** Covers manufacturing defects, latent hardware malfunctions, and authenticity discrepancies occurring within 30 days of confirmed delivery date.
- **Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) Standard Warranty:** Standard 12 to 24-month manufacturer warranties covering parts and labor, serviced directly via OEM authorized service centers.
- **NovaCare Extended Protection:** Optional supplemental warranty purchased during checkout covering accidental liquid damage, drop damage, and power surge failures for up to 36 months.

1.3 Proof of Purchase & Authenticity Validation

Document / Element	Validation Requirement	Verification Interface	Rejection Criteria
Tax Invoice	Digital tax invoice issued by NovaCart.	OMS Invoice Vault	Handwritten or unverified 3rd-party receipts.
Serial / IMEI Barcode	Matches serial logged during warehouse outbound scan.	Serial Match Verification API	Defaced, scratched, or missing serial plates.
Warranty Registration Card	Filled and stamped by authorized seller.	OEM Vendor Portal	Unregistered products where OEM enforces registration.
Physical Condition	Free from unauthorized third-party repair traces.	ASC Intake Report	Stripped screws, broken tamper seals, aftermarket solder.

Section 2: Dead-On-Arrival (DOA) Protocols & First-Line Diagnostics

2.1 Dead-On-Arrival (DOA) Classification: An electronic device, home appliance, or motorized item is designated as DOA if it fails to power up, exhibits critical display artifacts, or suffers severe functional failure within 7 calendar days of delivery.

2.2 Tier-1 Technical Troubleshooting Steps

- **Smartphones / Tablets:** Conduct hard reboot cycle (Hold Power + Volume Down for 20 seconds). Inspect charging port for debris using flashlight. Test with certified secondary OEM charger for 30 minutes.
- **Laptops & PC Accessories:** Disconnect peripherals, perform hard static discharge (hold power button for 30s without AC adapter), reseat external batteries if modular, check BIOS post screen.
- **Smart Home & Audio:** Perform hardware factory button reset, power cycle Wi-Fi router (2.4GHz vs 5GHz channel isolation), confirm firmware update via companion application.

2.3 Immediate DOA Replacement Dispatch Workflow

Step	Responsible Party	Action Items	SLA Standard
Triage Intake	CSR Tier-1	Execute diagnostics via remote video call or photos.	Within 15 minutes of call.
DOA Certification	Technical Support Desk	Validate defect matches hardware malfunction criteria.	2 business hours max.
Reverse Pickup	Express Courier	Doorstep pickup of defective unit with barcode check.	Within 24 hours.
Advance Replacement	Warehouse Ops	Dispatch brand new unit from closest regional fulfillment center.	Dispatched within 12h of DOA sign-off.

Section 3: OEM Service Networks, On-Site Repairs & Escalations

3.1 Direct OEM Escalation Pathways: For items experiencing issues outside the NovaCart 30-day initial window, customer service facilitates direct liaison with manufacturer Authorized Service Centers (ASCs).

3.2 Service Modality by Category

- **On-Site Home Service (Major Appliances / Large TVs):** Brand technician dispatched directly to customer residence within 48 to 72 business hours. CSR books service token via integrated Brand B2B Bridge API.
- **Carry-In Service (Mobile Phones / Laptops / Audio):** Customer visits local certified ASC. CSR provides exact authorized center address, contact telephone, and active pre-authorized CRM reference code.
- **Mail-In Depot Service (Specialty & Boutique Tech):** Prepaid shipping kit dispatched to customer to mail device directly to brand regional repair depot.

3.3 OEM Delay Escalation Guidelines

OEM Delay Condition	Escalation Level	Action Protocol	Customer Compensation
ASC Part Out of Stock > 14d	Brand Liaison Lead	Issue formal demand letter for unit replacement.	NovaCart issues $20 loyalty credit for delay.
Unresolved Repair > 21d	Vendor Management Team	Authorize Commercial Replacement Unit (CRU).	Swap with brand new identical or upgraded model.
Repeated Failure (3+ repairs)	Senior Service Director	Mandatory lemon-law buyback protocol.	Issue 100% platform credit refund to customer.
ASC Refusal / Dispute	Legal Compliance Desk	Investigate service denial reason; audit technician report.	NovaCart covers repair cost if refusal was illegitimate.

Section 4: Safety Recalls, Hazardous Defects & Lemon Policies

4.1 Critical Safety Incident Handling: Any product report involving electrical sparks, battery swelling, fire, explosion, chemical leakage, or physical injury must be escalated as a Category Zero (P0-Emergency) incident within 30 minutes.

4.2 P0 Critical Incident Protocol Checklist

- 1. **Customer Safety Directives:** Instruct customer immediately to disconnect power, move device away from flammable materials, and cease usage. Do NOT attempt to turn on.
- 2. **Evidence Collection:** Secure high-resolution photographs of damaged device, serial number tag, wall outlet/charging equipment, and surrounding area.
- 3. **SKU Quarantine:** Immediate algorithmic freeze placed on catalog SKU in OMS to prevent further consumer sales across platform.
- 4. **Product Recovery:** Specialist courier dispatched with fire-resistant hazmat container to recover affected unit for forensic lab analysis.

4.3 Standard Customer Resolution Templates

> ***Script - Technical Triage Walkthrough:*** *'Mr./Ms. [Customer], to make sure we resolve this quickly without requiring an inconvenient repair center visit, I'd like to guide you through a 2-minute diagnostic check to confirm if this is a software freeze or hardware failure. May I verify if you have the device in hand?'*

> ***Script - DOA Replacement Confirmation:*** *'Thank you for providing the diagnostic photographs. Our technical team has confirmed this unit is Dead-on-Arrival. We have dispatched a brand new replacement under tracking #[AWB] via priority air, and our courier will collect the defective unit at the same time.'*

FixFlow AI - Customer Answer Guidance

Supplement to 03 Product and Warranty SOP

Scope

Implementation guidance for FixFlow AI; not a change to the four-page NovaCart policy. Preserve the original warranty, DOA, inspection, safety and replacement requirements.

Scenario 4 - broken blender

A broken blender is a possible defective appliance, but its purchase date, exact failure, inspection outcome and eligibility are unknown. Explain the documented defect/DOA pathways without asserting that DOA certification has occurred or a replacement was dispatched.

Expected customer-facing answer

"I am sorry the blender arrived broken. NovaCart documents defect coverage and a technical assessment process for faulty products. If the appliance has a severe functional failure within seven calendar days of delivery, the DOA procedure may apply after verification. Please initiate a damaged or defective item request through your orders dashboard and provide photographs of the issue. The support team will need to verify the defect and applicable remedy before a replacement can be confirmed."

Timelines and conditions

The SOP lists internal steps and conditional SLAs for DOA certification, reverse pickup and dispatch after sign-off (Section 2.3). Do not translate these into a guaranteed arrival date or claim any step was completed. The return SOP may also govern category-specific return eligibility and photographic evidence.

Safety escalation

Electrical sparks, battery swelling, fire, explosion, chemical leakage or injury trigger the original SOP Section 4 P0 escalation procedure. Do not advise operating or troubleshooting a potentially hazardous unit.

Human approval and citations

Explaining replacement policy is not replacement approval. No agent may claim a dispatch, refund or technician decision without verified case data. If a refund of INR 500 or more is actually requested for execution, backend human approval applies. Cite retrieved customer-visible policy chunk IDs.